



CHARGED: A policeman escorting (from left), Devakanan, Mathews Simon, Sugumaran and Prabakaran into the courtroom to be charged yesterday.

Four charged with murdering factory worker

KUALA LUMPUR, Tues. — Four men were charged in the Selayang magistrate's court today with murdering a factory worker by attacking him with a stick, iron rod, stone and parang.

Devakanan Kuppusamy, 28, Mathews Simon Anthony, 29, Sugumaran Letchumanan, 27, and Prabakaran Sanathar Singh, 19, were charged with causing the death of Mohd Hanafiah Ishak, 35.

The offence was allegedly committed at Pencawang Maxis Kampung Desa Aman Puri, Batu 11, Sungai Buloh, Gombak between 11.30pm on Dec 31 last year and 9.25pm the next day.

All four appeared calm when produced before magistrate Nur Azhar Kassim.

Lawyer Rajpal Singh represented Devakanan, a grocery store owner, and Mathews Simon, a van driver.

Sugumaran, a grass-cutter, and Prabakaran, unemployed, were unrepresented. No plea was recorded.

Rajpal informed the court his clients claimed that during remand they were beaten by police and had bruises to show.

"I believe that the rest, too, were beaten up, so I urge the court to allow them to make a police report," he said, as the four accused then took off their shirts to show the magistrate

their bruises.

Nur Azhar told them to make a police report and ordered the four to be sent to the Selayang Hospital for a medical check-up.

Yesterday, Devakanan and Mathews Simon were charged with attempting to steal a woman's handbag and necklace at 2.10am in front of a house at Taman Indah Perdana, Gombak, on Jan 1.

Prabakaran was charged with the same offence on Jan 6. The three were alleged to have committed the offence with another person still at large. They pleaded not guilty.

Both cases will be re-mentioned on May 20.